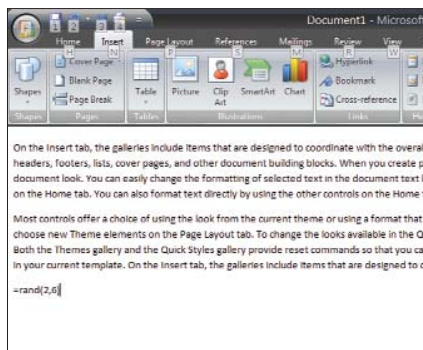




The new random text generator is a lot better



Random Text

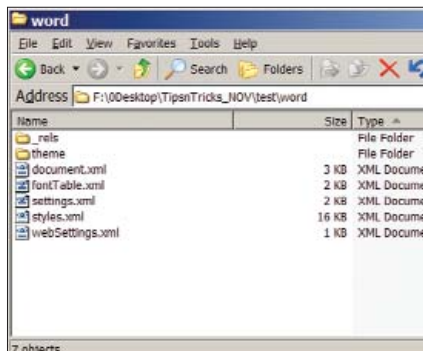
In order to create a design, you often need to add text. However, sometimes you may find that you don't have the text ready, or that you haven't yet got down to writing it all out. In such cases you can use Office's random text generator. This feature was always available in previous versions of office as well, but only in Office 2007 have Microsoft made it properly functional. Basically, in older Office versions, the line "The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog" would be repeated as many times as you decided. However, in Office 2007, when you generate random lines, you actually get readable text.

In order to do this, just type in `"=rand(X,Y)"` without the quotes and press [Enter]. Here, "X" is the number of paragraphs you want and "Y" is the number of lines each paragraph will have. You can also use the command `"=rand()"` and press [Enter] to generate about three paragraphs of lines.



The X Factor

Those of you who have already started using the Office 2007 Beta we provided in our DVD, or have downloaded it, will have already noticed that the default file format has an extra "X" extension. So MS Word 2007 files will have the ".docx" format, MS Excel 2007 has ".xlsx", etc. A lot of us have heard or read about this format being XML (eXtensible Markup Language)-enabled. Apart from the advantages of



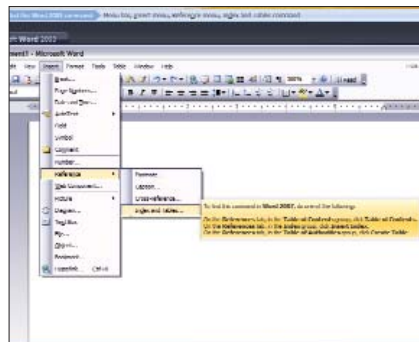
The new X file type is just zipped XML files

using XML tags to classify and sort data, the "X" format also results in much smaller files. This is because Office 2007 also Zips its documents in the process. For those of you who do not have Office 2007, opening .docx or .xlsx files shows just junk characters.

After providing our readers with Office 2007, we got quite a few queries from people who hadn't installed it. The problem was that a lot of people *did* start using Office 2007, leaving the rest scratching their heads about what to do with all these new .docx and .xlsx files that they were receiving from friends.

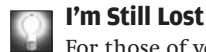
The solution is quite simple, really: since Office 2007 documents are nothing more than a lot of XML documents Zipped into one file, you can actually rename the file to .zip and then extract the contents. You will end up with a whole load of .xml files, which will contain your data.

Now, depending on the filetype (.docx, .xlsx, etc.), you will find either a "Word" folder or an "XL" folder that will contain your data. If the file contained any images, you will also find them here. If you want the data, open the



Using the online tutorial to understand new Office 2007 commands

XML file in an XML Editor, and you should be able to extract it.



I'm Still Lost

For those of you who just cannot get the hang of the new interface, there's still hope. In true Microsoft style, there's a guide available for everything, and comprehensive help. If you're used to the older Office 2003 interface, and want to know how to go about translating your actions into Office 2007 commands, things couldn't have been easier.

If you have an Internet connection, you can get a Web-based tutorial for Word, Excel and PowerPoint 2007 here:

MS Word:

<http://officebeta.iponet.net/en-us/word/HA100744321033.aspx>

MS Excel:

<http://officebeta.iponet.net/en-us/excel/HA101491511033.aspx>

MS PowerPoint:

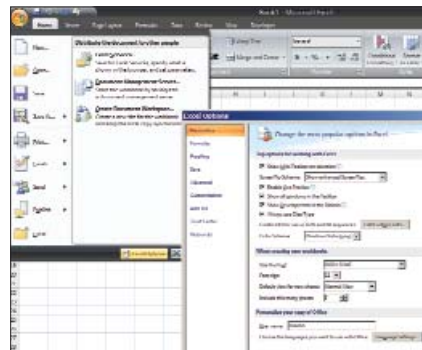
<http://officebeta.iponet.net/en-us/powerpoint/HA101490761033.aspx>

Just start the tutorial you want and go about using the commands you're used to. Then watch the screen carefully, because you will be shown the placements of the same commands in the Ribbon.



The Logo

The new Office 2007 logo on the top left of your screen is more than just a pretty sight. It also functions as the old File menu. Of course, there are many

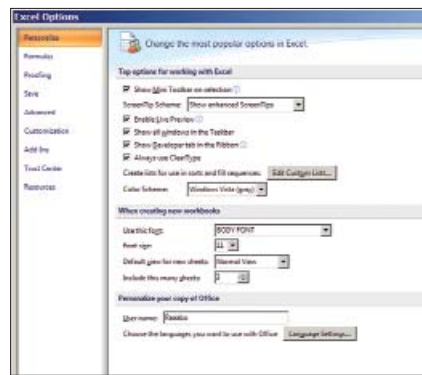


The new file menu, and MS Office options

more options here than in older versions of MS Office. As in the screenshot above, you will see the following new options:

Finish: This is where you will go once you're done with your document. The Properties option under here will let you set the document properties, such as Author, Title, Category, and even add comments. The Inspect Document option will let you check your document for comments, revisions, metadata, extra XML code, personal information, headers, footers, watermarks, hidden text, and more. You can also add digital signatures, mark the document as finalised, and check for compatibility issues with older versions of Office.

Publish: You can use the Publish option to post the document on a blog or a document management server, or even make a new document workspace where people with permissions can access it, both locally and over the Net.



A closer look at the options dialog box